CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

AMAZON FBA SELLER IN THE AI ERA

Your product on the world's biggest shelf — rented from a landlord who changes the rules whenever it likes.

★ TL;DR — Around $75K a year for a seller with a solid product line, startable in 1–6 months. The catch: inventory is bought with your money months before it sells — cash flow, not product ideas, kills most sellers. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

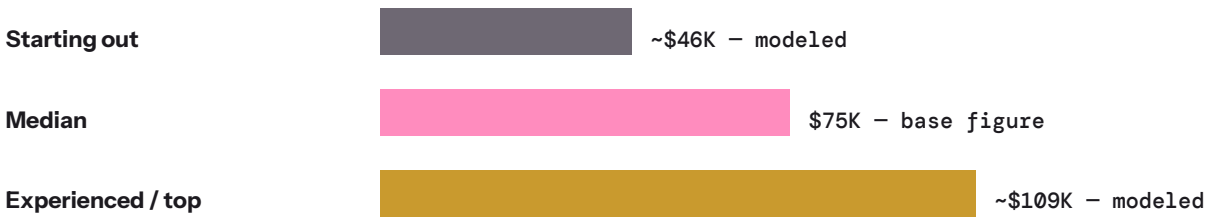
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$75K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK MEDIUM

- FBA handles storage, shipping and returns — you handle product, capital and the listing.
- Private label is a margins game: source cost, fees and ads decide everything.
- The platform is both your best channel and your biggest risk: policy and fee changes land without asking.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Amazon FBA Seller is a ~$75K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A AMAZON FBA SELLER ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Research products and keywords, analyze competitors' reviews for fixable complaints
- ✓ Negotiate with suppliers, manage production, quality checks and freight
- ✓ Build listings: photos, copy, pricing — and manage ad campaigns
- ✓ Watch inventory levels, cash flow and account health like a pilot watches fuel

Think: running a tiny import company whose only store is a very powerful, very moody mall.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
AI now does keyword research, review mining, listing drafts and ad bid management. Product scouting that took weeks takes an evening.	Capital judgment stays human: which product deserves five figures of your money, which supplier is bluffing, when to cut a dying product. AI reads the data; you bet the cash.

⚠ **Beginners die by inventory: a garage (or warehouse bill) full of a product that ranked on page nine. And account suspensions, hijacked listings and fee creep are not rare events — they are weather.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ A real product business without a storefront or staff ✓ Fully remote once the supply chain runs ✓ A working brand can be sold as an asset	✗ Serious cash sits in inventory for months ✗ You live by one platform's rulebook ✗ Launch season means ads eating margin before reviews arrive

Good fit? A numbers-first operator with starting capital who treats product research like due diligence and can stomach slow, lumpy returns.
Bad fit? You need your seed money back next month, or you plan to copy a bestseller and undercut it by a dollar.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — PRIVATE LABEL, ONE PRODUCT DONE RIGHT	DOOR B — WHOLESALE AND BRAND DISTRIBUTION
The standard route: find an existing product with proven demand and fixable complaints, source your improved version, brand it, and launch with reviews earned honestly. One product, fully funded, beats five products starved.	Buy established brands' products at wholesale and resell them on the platform. Less margin, less product risk, no product development — the game becomes supplier relationships and buying discipline.

Smart move: Mine the one-star reviews of the top three competitors before you source anything. Your product brief is literally their complaint list, fixed — that is the cheapest R&D; in business.
Where you land after: A small brand with several products and steady rank — then expansion to other marketplaces or selling the brand itself.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
LEARN THE	RESEARCH ONE	OPEN THE	SOURCE WITH	LAUNCH LIKE	MANAGE INVENTORY

STEP 1 — Learn the fee stack before products

FREE · 1-2 WEEKS

- Model a real product end to end: source, freight, referral and FBA fees, ad cost, returns. If the margin only works at fantasy prices, walk away.
- Set your capital honestly — inventory plus launch ads plus a mistake reserve.

STEP 2 — Research one product to death

FREE · 2-4 WEEKS

- Demand proven by existing sales, complaints you can fix, size and weight that keep freight sane.
- Check patents and trademarks early — a great product you cannot legally sell is a tuition payment.

STEP 3 — Open the seller account properly

$40/MO + SETUP · 1-2 WEEKS

- Register as a professional seller, complete tax and identity verification, set up business banking.
- Register the business as a real company — you are importing goods, act like it.

STEP 4 — Source with samples and inspections

CAPITAL · 4-8 WEEKS

- Order samples from several suppliers, compare ruthlessly, then negotiate price, packaging and quality terms.
- Use a prep and inspection step before goods ship — defects discovered by customers cost ten times more.

STEP 5 — Launch like it is a campaign

AD BUDGET · 2–4 WEEKS

- Listing first: photos that answer every objection, copy built from buyer language in reviews.
- Ads on from day one, priced into the plan — page one visibility is bought, then earned by sales.

STEP 6 — Manage inventory and cash weekly

PAID · ONGOING

- Reorder on lead time, not on hope — stockouts kill ranking you paid to build.
- Kill or clear slow products fast; warehouse fees on dead stock are a silent second rent.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- □ Today: model the full fee stack on one example product until the math scares you appropriately.
- □ Days 1–30: research products, open the seller account, register the business, shortlist one product.
- □ Days 31–60: order and torture-test samples, negotiate, place the first production order.
- □ Days 61–90: build the listing, prepare the launch, ship inventory to the warehouse.
- □ Day 90: your first product is live or landing — the business is now inventory, ads and cash discipline.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ CASH FLOW IS THE REAL PRODUCT. ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.